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Section Title(S): Grandparents.

Grandparents.

The hierarchy of age and the strictly patrilineal tendency of the Zulus makes the father's father simply a "great" father (*uḁaḁamkhulu*), a father who has authority even over your own father. The father's father must be shown the greatest respect. He orders you about and he must be implicitly obeyed. He teaches you what you should do, if you do not behave properly. The mother's father, on the other hand, though called by the same terms, *uḁaḁamkhulu* or simply *ukhulu* or *ukoko* (progenitor or ancestor), gives you the indulgence you expect at the kraal of your mother's people; but you do not play or joke with him. The mother's mother, *umakhulu*, *umamekhulu* or simply *ukhulu*, or *ukoko*, is the one who pets and spoils you, with whom you may play and whom you may tease. If you take her things she will hit you playfully with a stick but she will not allow anyone else to hit you, so you can do just what you please. One informant working in Johannesburg says that if he goes home to Zululand, even if only for a few days, he will always go to visit his mother's mother at her kraal. The father's mother, called by the same terms as the mother's mother, may also be teased and played with, but the relationship with her is not quite so good as that between the mother's mother and the grandchild. The behaviour pattern here is more on the lines of that towards a father, tempered, of course, by her sex and the indulgence born of old age. She is also in the same kraal as her grandchild, and when she is younger, has authority over him.¹

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¹ Some informants maintain that there is no real difference between your behaviour to the mother's mother and that to the father's mother.

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